

When NOT to Use Articles

Chart

Rules	Common Exceptions
<i>No articles</i>	<i>Articles</i>
Plural and uncountable nouns used for talking about things in general	
Proper nouns for people, places, and languages	Use “the” - if it the name contains a common noun (e.g., “states,” “kingdom,” “republic,” “ocean,” etc.) - if the proper noun in plural (e.g., Netherlands)
Daily meals	
Names of sports or games	
Certain places being used for their pupose (education, religion, healthcare, law / justice, work, home, bed, sea)	- Places talked about as a location - Public or commercial places (store, bank, etc.)
“By” plus a form of transportation	“By” meaning “next to”
Abstract ideas	Abstract ideas that are specific
Titles and ranks + names	Titles and ranks <i>without</i> names
Dates, times, holidays	An article is needed: - when there is a modifier of description - if we are being specific - if it is a set phrase - if we mean one of many - If we are talking about a specific date and the <i>number</i> comes <i>first</i>.

25 Practice Questions

Choose the correct sentence if we are talking about something in *general*.

Question 1:

- A. The teachers help students learn.
- B. Teachers help students learn.

Question 2:

- A. Apples are good for you.
- B. The apples are good for you.

Question 3:

- A. We had breakfast at 8 a.m.
- B. We had the breakfast at 8 a.m.

Choose the correct sentence if we are talking about something *specific*.

Question 4:

- A. I didn't like the music at the party.
- B. I didn't like music at the party.

Question 5:

- A. The lunch we had yesterday was delicious.
- B. Lunch we had yesterday was delicious.

Choose the correct sentence.

Question 6:

- A. The Spain is a beautiful country.
- B. Spain is a beautiful country.

Question 7:

A. England is located in the United Kingdom.

B. England is located in United Kingdom.

Question 8:

A. He wants to visit the Philippines.

B. He wants to visit Philippines.

Question 9:

A. She wants to visit the Canada.

B. She wants to visit Canada.

Question 10:

A. He plays the tennis every weekend.

B. He plays tennis every weekend.

Fill in the articles. Write an X if there should not be an article.

Question 11:

He stood by ____ car.

Question 12:

He went to ____ New York by plain.

Question 13:

Jim goes to ____ school to study.

Question 14:

I went to ____ bank to get my check.

Question 15:

Many people value ____ happiness.

Question 16:

I spoke to ____ professor after class.

Question 17:

____ Doctor Jones called yesterday.

Are the following sentences correct? Write a ✓ if it is correct and an X if it is not.

Question 18:

Her birthday is in the August.

Question 19:

We watched fireworks on New Year's Eve.

Question 20:

I didn't go to bed until after the midnight.

Question 21:

Let's meet at same time tomorrow.

Question 22:

He goes jogging at sunrise.

Question 23:

Independence Day is on the 4th of July.

Question 24:

Christmas is celebrated on the December 25st.

Question 25:

It was dark and stormy night.

Answers

1. B
2. A
3. A
4. A
5. A
6. B
7. A
8. A
9. B
10. B
11. the
12. X (no article)
13. X (no article)
14. the
15. X (no article)
16. the
17. X (no article)
18. X (corrected: Her birthday is in ~~the~~ August.)
19. ✓
20. X (corrected: I didn't go to bed until after ~~the~~ midnight.)
21. X (corrected: Let's meet at the same time tomorrow.)
22. ✓
23. ✓

24. X (corrected: Christmas is celebrated on ~~the~~ December 25th.)

25. X (corrected: It was a dark and stormy night.)